APPSC MCQ Tricks

Patterns read from 5,165 APPSC previous-year questions (Group 1, Group 2 and other APPSC screening tests, with the Commission's keys), set against 2,478 UPSC Prelims and 18,956 other state-PSC questions. Every number below is counted from those papers.

> **The one-line summary.** APPSC is a **fact-recall exam with an Andhra Pradesh tilt**: about half its questions are direct one-liners (who / what / which / when / where) and one in five is about Andhra Pradesh. The modern paper (2021-25) is moving: longer questions, more statements and Assertion-Reason, a quarter on AP, more report data. Win it by knowing crisp facts, AP data and the latest reports, then use the answer-shape habits below to settle the questions you half-know.

0. The modern APPSC paper (2021-2025) - what changed

1,840 questions from APPSC papers of 2021-2025 against 895 from 2010-2019. Prepare for the right-hand column.

Share of questions that are ...	2010-2019	2021-2025
Statement-based ("consider the following")	1%	**12%**
Assertion-Reason	0%	**3%**
Match the following	2%	**3%**
Negative (NOT / INCORRECT)	6%	**9%**
Report / data ("As per ... Survey / Index")	3%	**7%**
About Andhra Pradesh	13%	**26%**
Tied to a recent year	15%	**27%**
Schemes / missions	4%	**7%**
Superlatives (first, largest ...)	11%	**10%**
Average question length	88 characters	**162 characters**

- **Questions are nearly twice as long.** The modern paper wraps a fact in context ("As per the Socio-Economic Survey 2023-24 ...", "Which of the following statements regarding ... is/are correct?"). Read the last line first to see what is actually asked.
- **Statement-based questions jumped from almost none to about one in eight**, and Assertion-Reason now appears. These are 2-statement and 3-statement sets with codes ("Only I", "Both I and II", "Neither") - practise judging each statement on its own.
- **Andhra Pradesh doubled** to about a quarter of the paper: AP economy data, AP schemes by name, AP geography and the formation / bifurcation history.
- **Report-based and year-tagged questions doubled**: the latest Survey, Budget, index rank, the scheme or event of the last 1-2 years. Static facts alone no longer carry the paper.

- **Still mostly single-fact at heart**: even the long statement questions test one standard fact per statement - not UPSC-style fine print.

1. What kind of questions APPSC asks

Question type	APPSC count	APPSC share	UPSC share
Direct one-liner (what/which)	2261	44%	32%
Superlative / first / largest	585	11%	10%
Negative (NOT / incorrect / false)	470	9%	10%
Scheme / programme / mission	446	9%	8%
Data / number fact	291	6%	1%
Where / place	288	6%	3%
Definition / term / known as	285	6%	7%
Who / person	277	5%	3%
Statement-based (consider the following)	272	5%	42%
Fill in the blank	216	4%	0%
When / year / date	213	4%	3%
How many statements/pairs	175	3%	4%
Match the following	145	3%	7%
Article / Schedule / Amendment number	122	2%	3%
Assertion-Reason	92	2%	2%
Chronological / sequence	54	1%	2%

A question can fall in more than one type (a "NOT" question about a scheme counts under both); "Direct one-liner" means none of the other shapes.

- **Direct one-liners dominate** (44% of APPSC vs 32% of UPSC). Your notes must give the **one exact fact** - the name, the year, the place, the number - not only the idea.
- **Statement questions: rare in the old papers, rising fast** (5% of all APPSC questions, but about one in eight since 2021; UPSC 42%). They stay short: 2-4 statements, codes like "Only I", "Both I and II", "Neither".
- **Superlatives and firsts** (11%): first, largest, highest, longest, oldest - in India and in AP. Keep a "firsts and largests" list per subject.
- **Schemes and programmes** (9%): name, launch year, ministry, target group, what it pays. AP state schemes are asked by name.
- **Data questions** (6%) start with "As per ..." / "According to ..." a report: Socio-Economic Survey of AP, Union and AP Budgets, India State of Forest Report, NITI Aayog indices, Census 2011, RBI. The question is the report's headline number.
- **Fill in the blank** (4%) is an APPSC habit UPSC almost never uses: the blank is always a single word or number from a standard sentence.

Examples

Direct one-liner

Which Governor-General is associated with the ' Doctrine of Lapse '?

1. Cornwallis
2. Ripon
3. Curzon
4. **Dalhousie**

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

When was the Hyderabad State Congress formed?

1. **1938**
2. 1935
3. 1932
4. 1929

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Who was called the Father of Indian Renaissance?

1. Tilak
2. Gokhale
3. Gandhi
4. **Raja Rammohan Roy**

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Report / data ("As per ...")

As per the Indian Constitution, in the Union Council of Ministers,

1. **All the Ministers are equal**
2. Cabinet Ministers are superior to other ministers
3. Deputy Ministers are superior to Ministers of State, but lower than Cabinet Ministers in rank a se
4. Ministers without portfolios are the lowest in rank in the Council of Ministers

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

As per the succession of Prime Ministers of India, which order is correct: a) Indira Gandhi b) Rajiv Gandhi c) Charan Singh d) Morarji Desai e) Chandrashekhar f) Gulzari Lal Nanda

1. **f, a, d, c, b, e**
2. f, d, b, e, a, c
3. f, b, d, e, c, a
4. d, a, b, c, f, e

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

According to 2010 Human Development Index calculated (Compiled and Computed from UNDP Human Development Report) for 169 countries, what is the rank of India?

1. 105
2. 115
3. **119**
4. 128

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Fill in the blank

The _____, an experimental satellite communications project launched in India in 1975, was the first attempt to use space technology for education.

1. **Satellite Instructional Television Experiment**
2. Television Infrared Observation Satellite Program
3. Central Television Experiment Mission
4. Telstar Mission

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_____ is the flagship initiative set up by the NITI Aayog to promote innovation and entrepreneurship across the country.

1. Sardar Patel Innovation Mission
2. **The Atal Innovation Mission**
3. Mahatma Innovation Mission
4. Kaushal Navin Lakshay

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2. The keywords inside the question

- **Negative questions are printed in CAPITALS** in APPSC papers: NOT, INCORRECT, NOT CORRECT, FALSE, EXCEPT, "wrongly listed", "wrongly matched". About 9% of questions are negative. Circle the capital word, then mark each option T or F - the answer is the single F.
- **"Which of the following ..."** is the most common opener. Read all four options before answering: "Which of the following is the deep-water port" has exactly one fully correct option and three that are real but wrong (other ports).
- **"As per / According to / In the year"** means the answer is tied to that report or year. Choose the figure from *that* edition, not the latest one you remember.
- **Qualifiers decide the answer**: "primarily", "most important", "best suitable", "mainly", "first", "largest". APPSC takes the standard textbook answer (NCERT, Laxmikanth, the AP Socio-Economic Survey), not an exception.
- **"Match the following"** (3%) is the APPSC way to test 4 facts at once - find the one pair you are surest of and eliminate codes; you rarely need all four.
- **Assertion-Reason** is rare (92 questions) and almost always in the newer screening tests.

Negative

Identify the incorrect statement on the contributions of Jainism:

1. The early Jainas adopted Prakrit to preach their doctrines
2. Their religious literature was written in Ardhamagadhi
3. The early Jainas discarded Sanskrit language. 8
4. **They never used Apabhramsa for the earliest important works of Jainism**

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Identify the incorrect statement on extra-tropical cyclones:

1. These develop in the mid and high latitudes
2. **They do not have a clear frontal system**
3. They affect a large area as compared to the tropical cyclones
4. They can originate over the land and sea

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Consider the following: I. Dry winter season II. No dry season III. Dry hot summer IV. Dry and very severe winter Which of the above are not the characteristic features of Mediterranean Climate?

1. I, II and III
2. **I, II and IV**
3. II, III and IV
4. I, III and IV

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Match the following

Match the following: An List-I (Bhakti Saint) movement) A. Vallabhacharya List-II (Area of the Or B. I. Uttar Pradesh wa B. Tulsidas C. Sri Chaitanya D. Tukaram II. Gujarat III. Bengal IV. Maharashtra Choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

1. A-1, B-II, C-III, D-IV
2. A-II, B-I, C-IV, D-III
3. **A-II, B-I, C-III, D-IV**
4. A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

Match the following: List-I List-II (Name of the Ruler) (Position of the Ruler) A. Husain Ali Khan I. One of the Saiyid brothers B. Murshid Quli Khan II. The ruler of Bengal C. Chin Qilich Khan III. The Nizam of Hyderabad D. Safdar Jung IV. The Nawab of Awadh Choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

1. **A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV**
2. A-II, B-I, C-IV, D-III
3. A-II, B-I, C-III, D-IV
4. A-IV, B-III, C-II, D-I

APPSC Group-1 PYQ

3. Answer-shape habits (for the questions you half-know)

These are tie-breakers, not rules: use them only after you have eliminated what you can.

When an option says ...	questions	it was the answer	rate
Two items	179	89	50%
None of the above / neither	137	25	18%
Both	188	95	51%
All of the above / 1,2,3 all	120	47	39%
Only one item	75	25	33%

- **"Both" is the answer in about half the questions that offer it** (51%). In a two-statement APPSC question, if you are sure one statement is true and cannot fault the other, "Both" is the best bet.
- **"All of the above" wins 39%** of the times it appears (a blind pick is 25%). If you know two of the listed items are right, take "All".
- **"None of the above" / "Neither" is rarely right** (18%). Pick it only when you can positively reject every other option.
- **Extreme words are not a giveaway in APPSC.** Options with only / all / never / always / must were the answer 27% of the time (UPSC 25%) - the same as chance. Do not eliminate an option just because it says "only".
- **The longest option** was right 29% of the time (chance 25%) - a slight lean, useful only as a last resort.
- **Answer position**: option 1 27%, option 2 26%, option 3 26%, option 4 21%. Option 4 is the least used - do not "default to D".
- **Numbers and years**: when the four options are numbers, the smallest was right least often. Keys also differ between paper sets and between Initial and Final keys, so learn the answer by its **text**, never by its option number.

4. The Andhra Pradesh tilt

- **About one APPSC question in five is about Andhra Pradesh** (rivers, soils, minerals, ports, districts, schemes, economy, formation history), against 3% in UPSC.
- **History**: formation of Andhra State 1953 (Potti Sriramulu), Visalandhra and the Gentlemen's Agreement 1956, the 2014 bifurcation, social reformers (Kandukuri Veeresalingam), Satavahanas, Kakatiyas, Vijayanagara.
- **Geography**: Godavari / Krishna / Penna / Vamsadhara / Nagavali, red soils over most of AP, beach-sand minerals, bauxite, ports (Visakhapatnam, Gangavaram, Krishnapatnam), national parks (Papikonda, Sri Venkateswara).
- **Economy**: GSDP, growth and sector shares from the latest Socio-Economic Survey, AP Budget heads, agriculture (APCNF / natural farming, Rythu Bharosa Kendras), industrial policy, the new state's capital and corridor projects.
- **Schemes** are asked by the AP name ("YSR Cheyutha", "Amma Vodi", "Aarogyasri") - who it serves, what it gives, when it began. Keep a table of current AP schemes with these four columns.

5. Subject by subject

History & Culture

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (41%), Who / person (14%), Superlative / first / largest (9%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (6%), When / year / date (6%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. Later reorganisation of states - 1960s to 2000; creation of Telangana 2014 **(29)**
2. Linguistic reorganisation demand; Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State 1953 **(27)**
3. Formation of Andhra Pradesh 1956 - Visalandhra, Gentlemen's Agreement **(21)**
4. Social and religious reform in Andhra - Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Gurajada Apparao, Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu **(18)**
5. Satavahana administration, economy, coinage and Prakrit literature (Hala's Gathasaptasati) **(12)**
6. Andhra in the freedom movement - Alluri Sitarama Raju and the Rampa Rebellion, Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya **(12)**
7. Decline of the Mughal Empire - causes and historiography; the Later Mughals; regional successor states **(10)**
8. Telugu cinema and mass culture in Andhra Pradesh **(10)**
9. IVC seals, weights and measures, Harappan script (undeciphered features) **(10)**
10. Telugu language and literature to the 14th century - Nannaya, Tikkana, Errana, Palkuriki Somanatha **(10)**

Polity, Governance & Society

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (28%), Scheme / programme / mission (12%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (10%), Article / Schedule / Amendment number (8%), Superlative / first / largest (7%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. High Courts and subordinate judiciary; judicial review, judicial activism, PIL and judicial overreach debate **(20)**
2. Vice-President; Prime Minister and the Union Council of Ministers - Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 **(19)**
3. Important policies and programmes of the Government of Andhra Pradesh - welfare and social security **(18)**
4. Parliament - composition of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, qualifications, terms, special powers of Rajya Sabha **(15)**
5. Federal structure of India - features of federalism and unitary bias; Seventh Schedule (three lists), residuary powers **(13)**
6. Child welfare - ICDS, POSHAN Abhiyaan, mid-day meal (PM POSHAN), child marriage, malnutrition **(12)**
7. Preamble - text, keywords, 42nd Amendment; is the Preamble part of the Constitution (Berubari, Kesavananda) **(11)**

8. Budget in Parliament - stages, cut motions, appropriation and finance bills, Consolidated/Contingency/Public Account **(11)**
9. Women's welfare schemes - Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Mission Shakti, PMMVY, Ujjwala **(11)**
10. Sources of the Indian Constitution - borrowed features and their origin countries **(11)**

Economy (India & AP)

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (35%), Scheme / programme / mission (13%), Data / number fact (8%), Superlative / first / largest (7%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (7%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. Approaches and initiatives in AP agriculture - APCNF/ZBNF, horticulture, aquaculture, allied sectors **(29)**
2. Basic features of the Andhra Pradesh economy after bifurcation - GSDP, growth rate, sectoral shares **(24)**
3. Approaches and initiatives in AP industry - industrial policy, single desk, MSMEs, industrial nodes **(24)**
4. NITI Aayog initiatives - SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts Programme, Health/Education indices, Atal Innovation Mission **(18)**
5. National income concepts - GDP, GNP, NDP, NNP, factor cost vs market price, GVA, deflator **(18)**
6. Poverty eradication and livelihood programmes - DAY-NRLM, DAY-NULM, SHG movement **(16)**
7. AP state finances - revenue receipts and expenditure, debt and interest payments, latest AP Budget **(15)**
8. Five Year Plans I to XII - objectives, targets, achievements and failures of each **(15)**
9. Economic growth vs economic development; measures of development **(15)**
10. A.P. Reorganisation Act 2014 - structure, schedules and key provisions **(14)**

Geography (India, World & AP)

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (39%), Superlative / first / largest (14%), Where / place (10%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (8%), Definition / term / known as (5%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. Disaster management framework - hazard vs disaster, DM Act 2005, NDMA, early warning systems **(60)**
2. India - rocks and mineral belts; distribution of metallic and non-metallic minerals **(46)**
3. India - Peninsular drainage: east-flowing and west-flowing rivers, river basins, watershed **(41)**
4. Andhra Pradesh - drainage: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Vamsadhara, Nagavali; reservoirs and canals **(34)**
5. Andhra Pradesh - soil types and their distribution **(28)**
6. World - major rivers, lakes, seas, straits, canals and islands **(27)**

7. The universe and the solar system - origin theories, the Sun, planets, asteroids, comets, meteors **(26)**
8. India - the Northern Plains, the Peninsular Plateau, the Coastal Plains and the Islands **(23)**
9. Atmospheric disturbances - tropical cyclones, temperate cyclones, anticyclones, thunderstorms, tornadoes **(22)**
10. Elements and factors of climate; world climatic classification (Koeppen) **(22)**

Science, Technology & Environment

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (39%), Superlative / first / largest (9%), Scheme / programme / mission (8%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (8%), Definition / term / known as (5%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. Relevance of science and technology to day-to-day life - health, food, transport, communication, household **(78)**
2. Goals of sustainable development - the 17 SDGs, targets and India's SDG Index performance **(28)**
3. Health and environment - vector-borne and water-borne diseases, air pollution and health, antimicrobial resistance, One Health **(25)**
4. Environment - components; ecology, ecosystem, food chain and food web, energy flow, ecological pyramids **(21)**
5. Environmental hazards and disaster management - DM Act 2005, NDMA and NDRF, Sendai Framework, disaster types and mitigation **(18)**
6. Biotechnology - nature, scope, tools; applications in agriculture, medicine and industry **(15)**
7. Solid waste, plastic waste, e-waste, biomedical and construction waste - rules and management **(15)**
8. Air pollution - sources, pollutants, NAAQS, AQI, National Clean Air Programme, stubble burning **(14)**
9. Environmental legislation in India - Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, Environment (Protection) Act 1986 **(13)**
10. Climate change - greenhouse effect, greenhouse gases, radiative forcing, evidence and observed impacts **(12)**

Current Affairs

How it is asked: Direct one-liner (what/which) (39%), Superlative / first / largest (11%), Who / person (9%), Statement-based (consider the following) (7%), Negative (NOT / incorrect / false) (7%)

Most-asked topics (APPSC questions filed there):

1. Special topics: Awards and honours - national civilian awards, international prizes, film and literary awards **(6)**
2. Overview and data: International - summits, conferences and their outcomes **(4)**
3. Sep–Oct 2026: National - new central schemes, missions and their features **(4)**

4. Jun–Aug 2026: International - bilateral visits, defence deals and geopolitical developments **(4)**
5. Jun–Aug 2026: Sports - major tournaments, winners, records and hosting rights **(3)**
6. Apr–Nov 2025: Science and technology in news - space missions, defence tests, health and biotech developments **(3)**
7. Mar–May 2026: National - new central schemes, missions and their features **(3)**
8. Jun–Aug 2026: Books and authors; important days and their themes **(3)**
9. Mar–May 2026: Andhra Pradesh - projects, investments, MoUs, industrial and infrastructure developments **(2)**
10. Mar–May 2026: International - bilateral visits, defence deals and geopolitical developments **(2)**

6. APPSC vs UPSC - what to copy and what to skip

	APPSC	**UPSC Prelims**
Typical shape	Direct one-liner, 4 single-fact options	"Consider the following statements", "How many of the above"
Statements per question	2-4, codes like "I and II only", "Both"	3-4, often "only one / only two / all three"
Depth	Standard fact, the textbook answer	Fine distinctions, exceptions, recent reports
State content	~20% AP-specific	~3%
Current affairs	1-2 years before the exam; awards, sports, schemes, AP news	Concepts behind the news

Use UPSC questions for **which facts matter** (the exam angle) but answer APPSC questions at **APPSC depth**: one fact, the standard answer.

7. A checklist for every question

1. Spot the capital-letter word (NOT / INCORRECT / EXCEPT) and the qualifier (first, largest, primarily, as per ...).
2. Name the fact being tested in one phrase before reading the options.
3. Eliminate options that belong to a neighbouring fact (another port, another scheme, another year).
4. Statements: judge each on its own; with two statements and no fault found, "Both".
5. Half-known: "All of the above" if two items are surely right; avoid "None"; don't default to option 4; don't cut "only" options blindly.
6. Numbers / years: anchor to one fact you know (a Plan's start year, a Census figure) and count from it.

8. Topic by topic - how APPSC asks the most-asked topics

From reading every APPSC, UPSC and state-PSC question filed under each topic. The ten topics per subject with the most APPSC questions.

History & Culture

Later reorganisation of states - 1960s to 2000; creation of Telangana 2014 (23 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks APRA 2014 as pure number/structure recall: 12 Parts, 108 Sections, 13 Schedules; 'which Part deals with X' (Part V revenue, Part VIII services, Part XII amends Arts 371D/168); Section 8 Governor and common capital; appointed day 2 June 2014.
- Mulki/regional-agitation questions are cause-effect one-steppers: Jai Andhra caused by the SC Mulki judgment; ended by the Six-Point Formula; President's Rule 1973 due to Jai Andhra; Six-Point given effect by the 32nd Amendment (traps: 33rd, 'abolition of Mulki rules', 'repression').
- State-formation items are chronological-order or year-matching (Haryana 1966 -> Meghalaya/Tripura 1972 -> Karnataka rename 1973; J&K/Ladakh UTs 2019); APPSC does not go into Acts' clause details.

Formation of Andhra Pradesh 1956 - Visalandhra, Gentlemen's Agreement (19 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single facts: who was not a Gentlemen's Agreement signatory (Prakasam), name of the 1956 agreement, first CM (Sanjiva Reddy), first capital.
- Visalandhra Mahasabha details recur: founded Nov 1949 at Vijayawada by Ayyadevara Kaleswara Rao, first meeting Warangal 1950; 'Communists opposed linguistic states' is the planted false statement.
- CM chronology and tenure items are frequent (Sanjivayya 1960-62, Brahmananda Reddy 1964-71, Nadendla 31 days, Panchayat Raj under Sanjiva Reddy).
- Telangana-movement leaders (TPS founder Chenna Reddy, CM during 1969 = Brahmananda Reddy, Ramananda Tirtha) are filed here too.

Social and religious reform in Andhra - Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Gurajada Apparao, Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu (18 APPSC questions)

- APPSC overwhelmingly asks Veeresalingam one-liners: Vivekavardhini (1874) founder/year, Satihita Bodhini for women, Hitakarini Samaj, first girls' school, Rajasekhara Charitra = first Telugu novel, 'father of Telugu renaissance'.
- Other recurring APPSC facts: Bhogam abolition = Raghupathi Venkataratnam Naidu; Kanyasulkam = Gurajada; Prakasika (1896) = Gurajada; Vyavaharika Samaj = Gidugu; Kasiyatra Charitra = Enugula Veeraswamayya.
- Shapes are direct 'who founded/wrote' and simple correct-pair questions; traps swap journals among Veeresalingam, Kokkonda and Venkataratnam Naidu.
- Watch conflicting keys: G2 2025 Vivekavardhini (D. Rangacharyulu), Brahmo Samaj in combined AP keyed to Veeresalingam.

Linguistic reorganisation demand; Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State 1953 (18 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single facts: capital of Andhra State 1953 (Kurnool, asked 3+ times), date of Sriramulu's death (15 Dec 1952), who ended Sitaram's fast (Vinoba Bhave), Partition Committee chair (Kumaraswamy Raja).
- Recurring persons/places: Bapatla 1913 president B.N. Sarma who opposed separation; Cooum boundary = Raja of Panagal; Sri Bagh 1937 = Andhra-Rayalaseema; Justice Party govt -> Andhra University.
- Shapes used: session -> president match lists, chronological ordering (Dhar -> Visalandhra -> Sitaram fast -> SRC), first office holders (Speaker Nallapati Venkatramaiah, budget 1955-56 B. Gopala Reddy).
- Traps: Sri Bagh (1937) vs Gentlemen's Agreement (1956); Andhra State 1 Oct 1953 vs AP 1 Nov 1956; Dar (Constituent Assembly) vs JVP (Congress).

Andhra in the freedom movement - Alluri Sitarama Raju and the Rampa Rebellion, Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya (10 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks this topic almost entirely as direct single facts: Alluri's tomb (Krishnadevipeta), first PS attacked (Chintapalli), rebellion years (1922-24), Madras Forest Act (1882).
- Duggirala angles recur: leader of Chirala-Perala, Ramadandu volunteer corps (distractor Shanti Sena), title Andhra Ratna.
- Match-the-following of Andhra leaders -> movement/title/book (Veeraiah Chowdary-Pedanandipadu, Kaleswara Rao-Naa Jeevitha Katha, Tripuraneni-Kavi Raju).
- Trap: 'Andhra Shivaji' (Veeraiah Chowdary) vs 'Andhra Ratna' (Duggirala); Hyderabad State Congress 1938.

Telugu language and literature to the 14th century - Nannaya, Tikkana, Errana, Palkuriki Somanatha (9 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks author-work one-liners: Pavuluri Mallana = Ganita Sara Sangraha, Ketana = Abhinava Dandi (Dasakumara Charitra), Jayapa = Gaja-Sahini, Nannechoda = Kumarasambhavam.
- Statement-type items on Nannaya (Andhra Mahabharatam, Andhra Shabda Chintamani, Nandampudi agrahara) with keys sometimes differing from textbook versions.
- Not-correctly-matched pairs among Shiva Kavis (Palkuriki - Panditaradhya Charitra / Basava Puranam) are a recurring trap.
- UPSC/other PSC items cover epic versions in other languages (Pampa - Kannada); APPSC stays on Telugu poets and Kakatiya-court authors.

Decline of the Mughal Empire - causes and historiography; the Later Mughals; regional successor states (9 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks: correct chronology of Later Mughals, Koh-i-Noor plunderer (Nadir Shah), first/last Nizam, Nizam who took Subsidiary Alliance (Nizam Ali Khan, 1798).
- Match-the-person items (Husain Ali - Sayyid, Murshid Quli - Bengal, Chin Qilich Khan - Hyderabad, Safdar Jung - Awadh) are a recurring APPSC shape.
- Strong Hyderabad/Asaf Jahi tilt for AP: founder Mir Qamar-ud-din, Operation Polo 1948, last Nizam Osman Ali Khan.
- Other PSCs add epithets (Rangeela, Zinda Pir) and Third Panipat basics; historiography of decline rarely appears in PYQs.

Foundation of Vijayanagara - Harihara and Bukka, Vidyaranya; the Sangama dynasty (8 APPSC questions)

- Bulk of PYQs are one-liners: founders Harihara and Bukka (1336), Tungabhadra dam = Devaraya I, Abdur Razzaq = Devaraya II, embassy to China = Bukka I.
- APPSC-specific: founders as Kakatiya officials (Warangal link), Raichur Doab as main cause of wars, Devaraya II's literary hall Mutyalasala, 'odd one out' dynasties.
- Dynasty order Sangama-Saluva-Tuluva-Aravidu and the usurpations (Saluva Narasimha, Vira Narasimha) are a frequent statement item.
- Literary sources (Madhura Vijayam by Gangadevi, Sayana's Vedic commentaries, Sewell's A Forgotten Empire) recur.

Raja Rammohan Roy and the Brahmo Samaj; abolition of Sati; Debendranath and Keshab Chandra Sen (8 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct identification: Father of Indian Renaissance, founder of Brahmo Samaj / Tattvabodhini Sabha, Sati abolished by Bentinck.
- APPSC also asks organisation-place-year (Paramahansa Mandali, Poona 1849), chronological order of reformers, and 'not matched' reformer-body pairs.
- Other PSCs repeat: Raja title by Akbar II, died at Bristol, Atmiya Sabha first society, Adi Brahmo = Debendranath, Bharatiya Brahmo Samaj = Keshab, Sati 1829.
- Andhra tilt: Veeresalingam's Rajahmundry centre and the Andhra Brahmo trinity.

Reddi kingdoms of Addanki, Kondavidu and Rajahmundry - Prolaya Vema Reddi, Kumaragiri Reddi (7 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks one-fact items on Reddi culture: Puriti Pannu (Racha Vema), Sangeeta Chintamani (Pedakomati), Haravilasam (sea trade), Surambika's tank, Ghatika Yantra, Srinatha's works.
- Chronological ordering of rulers (Anavota -> Anavema -> Kumaragiri -> Pedakomati) is a recurring G2 shape.
- Key slips exist (Puriti Pannu keyed to Kataya Vema; tank name differs across years) - read options carefully.

Polity, Governance & Society

Important policies and programmes of the Government of Andhra Pradesh - welfare and social security (22 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks scheme-to-purpose and scheme-to-amount one-liners: Amma Vodi/Talliki Vandanam Rs 15,000 to mothers, Rythu Bharosa Rs 13,500 incl. Rs 6,000 PM-KISAN, Cheyutha Rs 75,000 over 4 years for women 45-60, Aasara = SHG loans outstanding on 11 April 2019.
- Launch dates are asked directly (Rythu Bharosa Oct 2019, Jagananna houses 3 June 2021, P4 on Ugadi 30 March 2025); pension step-ups (Rs 2,250 to Rs 2,500, Jan 2022).
- 'Which is NOT part of Navaratnalu' and old-name/new-name pairs are recurring traps; NTR Vaidya Seva Rs 25 lakh cover (May 2025) keyed.

High Courts and subordinate judiciary; judicial review, judicial activism, PIL and judicial overreach debate (18 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct facts: judicial review borrowed from USA, judicial activism originated in USA, PIL = Social Action Litigation pioneered by Krishna Iyer and Bhagwati, 224A consent of the President.
- Strong AP angle: separate AP High Court functioning at Amaravati from 1 Jan 2019, first (acting) CJ C. Praveen Kumar at Vijayawada, AP Reorganisation Act Sec. 30/31/32 match.
- APPSC also asks current-affairs court news (HC orders on AP districts/Amaravati, new SC judges, pendency 4.7 crore / 87% subordinate) and 'not an SC evolution' (exemptions to FRs).
- Other PSCs favour: retirement 62, resignation to President, President fixes HC strength, court of record (129/215), district judge (Art. 233/236), H.N. Sanyal Committee, PIL in SC and HC.

Vice-President; Prime Minister and the Union Council of Ministers - Articles 74, 75, 77, 78 (15 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: who elects the VP (both Houses), removal resolution first in Rajya Sabha (Art. 67), President resigns to VP, PM appointed by President, PM chairs Planning Commission/NITI.
- Size cap is a favourite: 91st Amdt, 15% of Lok Sabha (Union) and 15% / minimum 12 (States) - other PSCs repeat this almost verbatim.
- APPSC Group-1 uses 'choose the WRONG statement' on CoM (trap: President gets discretion in National Emergency) and constitutional equality of ministers.
- Records/firsts (first VP, diplomat VPs, PM succession order) and current incumbents appear as one-liners.

Federal structure of India - features of federalism and unitary bias; Seventh Schedule (three lists), residuary powers (13 APPSC questions)

- APPSC repeatedly asks 'who called India quasi-federal' (K.C. Wheare), 'federation with a centralising tendency' (Jennings), 'elephantine size' (H.V. Kamath).
- APPSC 'NOT a federal feature' items: Office of the Governor, CAG, 'allocation of financial resources'; Union of India = indissoluble union of States; First Schedule lists territories.
- List questions are single-subject: Banking -> Union, Forests -> Concurrent, Higher education not in State List, Entry 64 = institutions of national importance.
- Other PSCs favour Railway Police -> State, Economic planning -> Concurrent, Panchayati Raj -> State, Art. 249 Rajya Sabha 2/3 present and voting, 42nd Amendment education transfer.

Parliament - composition of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, qualifications, terms, special powers of Rajya Sabha (12 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks bare numbers: LS max 550 / present 543, RS 250 / 12 nominated, AP RS seats 11 (undivided 18), women in 2009 LS = 59, quorum one-tenth.
- Statement-type items test traps: RS not dissolved and 1/3 retire every two years, nominated fields exclude sport, no educational qualification, Anglo-Indian nomination ended by 104th Amdt.
- Rajya Sabha special/equal powers recur: Art. 249 authorises Parliament (not State Assemblies), equal status = CAG report + emergency approval, not money bills or VP removal.
- Privileges asked via 'which is correct' with civil-only freedom from arrest and both collective and individual privileges.

Governor - appointment, powers, discretionary powers, position and controversies (Article 200/201, Article 356 reports) (12 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single-fact article numbers: Art. 153 (one Governor for 2+ States, 7th Amendment), 155 appointment, 164 CM appointment, 213 ordinance, 356 PR.
- Statement-type traps: 'Governor quits immediately after term' (false), minimum age 35, max PR 3 years, never in Telangana/Chhattisgarh, reservation = central control.
- AP angle: number of PR spells in AP (1973 Jai Andhra; Andhra State 1954-55), first Governor C.M. Trivedi.
- Other PSCs favour discretion lists (UPSC 2014: report under 356 + reservation of bills), immunity under Art. 361, ordinance approved by State Legislature.

Women's welfare schemes - Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Mission Shakti, PMMVY, Ujjwala (12 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: Ujjwala is meant for women / its objective is free LPG to BPL women; RMK set up 1993; Stand-Up India for greenfield enterprises.
- Count/structure questions: MWCD schemes grouped under three umbrella missions; Mahila e-Haat = MWCD web marketing platform.
- 'Which is NOT correct' items on girl-child schemes (BBBP, Sukanya, Balika Samriddhi) and flagship-programme lists recur.

Child welfare - ICDS, POSHAN Abhiyaan, mid-day meal (PM POSHAN), child marriage, malnutrition (12 APPSC questions)

- APPSC repeats ICDS functionary questions: Anganwadi Worker as grass-root ICDS functionary; NIPCCD trains CDPOs
- Direct one-liners on launch facts: POSHAN Abhiyaan 2018, Mid-Day Meal 1995, Poshan Bhi Padhai Bhi launched by WCD Minister (May 2023)
- Scheme-identification items: Mission Vatsalya (child protection + SDGs), ALIVA (Nayagarh, Odisha), Akshaya Patra (largest MDM NGO), Vatsalya budget 2021-22
- Traps: ICDS vs NHM/ANM; PM POSHAN (Education) vs Poshan 2.0 (MWCD); Ujjawala vs Ujjwala

State legislature - Assembly and Legislative Council; creation and abolition of the Council (Article 169) (10 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: which states have Councils, Council composition fractions (EXCEPT form), officers of Assembly, Article range 168-212
- Recurring traps: 1/3-1/12-1/12-1/3-1/6 shares, Speaker resigns to Deputy Speaker, Speaker does not preside during own removal, Council only delays (no joint sitting)
- AP tilt: AP Reorganisation Act 2014 caps AP Council at 50; AP Council abolished 1985, revived 2007
- Art. 169 process: Assembly special majority, Parliament simple majority, not an Art. 368 amendment

Supreme Court - composition, appointment, collegium and NJAC, jurisdictions (original, appellate, advisory, writ) (10 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single facts: Parliament increases number of judges, first CJI H.J. Kania, 99th Amendment void in 2015, Chelameswar upheld NJAC, Art. 128 retired judges need CJI + President's consent.
- Other PSCs/UPSC repeat: Centre-State disputes = original jurisdiction (Art. 131), Art. 143 advisory, Art. 137 review, Art. 142 complete justice / curative petition, minimum 5 judges for constitutional questions.
- Removal traps: special majority in each House, Judges (Inquiry) Act 1968 (100 LS / 50 RS), Speaker can refuse motion, no judge removed; Soumitra Sen resigned in 2011.
- Appointments: ad hoc judges only in SC for quorum, no additional judges in SC, resignation to President, 10 years HC advocate.

Economy (India & AP)

Approaches and initiatives in AP industry - industrial policy, single desk, MSMEs, industrial nodes (21 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct policy numbers: Single Desk approvals in 21 days, mega status = 2,000 jobs, 16.2% APIIC plots for SC, 33% land for MSMEs, 26 cement plants (2014-15), 4.0 policies = 2024-29.
- Rank questions recur with specific reporting windows (FDI rank 12th/13th/14th, industrial output 7th) - window wording is the trap.
- 'Which is NOT a standard incentive' and 'which statement is incorrect' about the policy text (Foreign vs Fixed capital investment, GSDP share, facilitation timelines).
- Current-affairs company-location items (Pepper Motion-Punganur, Hindalco-Apple, APIIC-Union Bank MoU) appear in G2.

Basic features of the Andhra Pradesh economy after bifurcation - GSDP, growth rate, sectoral shares (20 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks AP economy as single-figure recall tied to a specific Survey/estimate: sector shares of GVA at current prices for a named year (2021-22 services 42%; 2022-23 36.19/23.36/40.45), 'record growth 11.43% in 2021-22', 'first in GSDP growth 2015-16', 'only state with double-digit growth 2015-16'.
- Match-the-following of sector/sub-sector to growth or share (2023-24 AE growth rates; 2024-25 sub-sector GVA shares: communications 2%, construction 8%, horticulture 10%, fishing 9%) is a recurring format; options are permutations of the same numbers.
- Vision documents are asked by target year (Vision 2029: most preferred investment destination by 2050; 2029 targets list) and Swarna Andhra basics (10 Padi Sutralu, P4 aim); not by rupee/dollar milestones.
- Trap is always the estimate stage and price basis: livestock leads at current prices, fishing at constant; AE vs FRE figures differ, so the year+stage must match the key.

Five Year Plans I to XII - objectives, targets, achievements and failures of each (19 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks plan -> theme one-liners: 11th 'faster and more inclusive', 12th 'faster, sustainable and more inclusive', heavy industry = Second, first priority to agriculture = First.
- Dates/periods: Fourth Plan launched 1969, Plan Holiday 1966-69, Rolling Plan 1978-80, Eighth began 1992; highest growth = Eleventh (APPSC), older PSCs keyed Tenth.
- Programme -> plan matching (CDP 1952, JRY Seventh, Women's Component Plan Ninth, RKVY Eleventh, 20-point programme 1975) recurs across PSCs.
- APPSC Group-1 also asks targets/data (11th Plan 9.5% AP target, 2002-03 growth, Second Plan pruning due to forex shortage).

NITI Aayog initiatives - SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts Programme, Health/Education indices, Atal Innovation Mission (17 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks AP's rank in the SDG India Index (overall 4th in 2020-21, SDG-7 1st, SDG-14 2nd, SDG-1 3rd) - straight recall with Roman-numeral or ordinal options.
- Publisher matching recurs: SDG India Index = NITI, Global SDG Report = UNSD, VNR = member states, NIF = MoSPI.
- SDG number-to-name items (SDG 13 climate, SDG 14 oceans, SDG 6 water, SDG 15 life on land) are frequent single-fact questions.
- Current-affairs MoUs/SoIs (NITI-UNICEF children 2022, NITI-UNDP 2023, E-FAST with WRI) and India's SDSN rank by year appear often.

Approaches and initiatives in AP agriculture - APCNF/ZBNF, horticulture, aquaculture, allied sectors (17 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct SES-figure items: RBKs 10,778 (SES 2023-24), Rythu Bharosa ₹13,500, egg rank 1st, oil palm output 17.81 lakh t, seafood export share 36%, cropping intensity 1.25, cultivated area 37%.
- Expansion/acronym items recur: RySS = Rythu Sadhikara Samstha, APCNF = Community Managed Natural Farming; Panta Sanjeevani = farm ponds; 'white gold' = cotton.
- Two-statement items on AP ranks (oil palm productivity 1st, mango 2nd) and institute-location items (VBRI Vijayawada, Indo-Israel CoE Palnadu).
- Year-specific SES numbers are the trap: APPSC always ties a figure to a named survey year.

Poverty eradication and livelihood programmes - DAY-NRLM, DAY-NULM, SHG movement (16 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct single facts: IRDP start year (1980), NREP/RLEGP in 6th Plan, SGSY launched April 1999 and now 'Aajeevika', NRLM borrowers = women SHGs.
- Strong AP tilt: SAPAP supported by UNDP, IKP full form and merger role, Velugu, MEPMA as urban poverty mission, Abhaya Hastham for SHG women, Janmabhoomi 1997.
- DAY-NULM asked as ministry (Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation) and current-affairs tie-ups (UNDP-DAY-NULM for women, 2023).
- Other PSCs favour chronology ordering (IRDP-NREP-DWCRA-JRY; IRDP-SGSY-NREGA-PMJDY), odd-one-out (MRTP, NSSF, CRY) and programmes merged into SGSY (JRY not included).

Economic reforms of 1991 - background, stabilisation and structural adjustment measures (15 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks the crisis signature (high inflation, low forex, large fiscal deficit), the 1991 rescue step (IMF loan by pledging gold) and 'what was NOT done' (demonetisation, nationalisation, capital-account convertibility).
- Globalisation-impact trap recurs in APPSC-G2: 'exports grew faster than imports' is the false statement; post-reform shift = enhanced global integration.
- APPSC-G1 asks conceptual one-liners: SAPs reduce fiscal imbalances for long-term growth, jobless growth because reforms were confined to the formal sector, railways not much affected.
- Other PSCs: year of reforms (1991, Rao/Manmohan), Chelliah = tax reforms, post-1991 changes (FDI, forex up; agriculture share not up).

A.P. Reorganisation Act 2014 - structure, schedules and key provisions (14 APPSC questions)

- Date of President's assent (1 March 2014) is asked repeatedly (5+ APPSC papers); trap options Feb / June 2014 (appointed day 2 June).
- APPSC asks section-number recall: Sec 95 equal higher-education opportunity, Sec 50-51 tax arrears/loans, Sec 26 Assembly 175 -> 225.
- Schedule-content questions: Constitution Schedules amended = First and Fourth; Schedule X lists 107 institutions; VII = list of funds.
- Odd administrative details also asked: judges' salaries split by population ratio, Greyhound centre common for 3 years, 2 advisors to common Governor.

Economic growth vs economic development; measures of development (11 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks concept-identification one-liners: key factor of Western model (economic growth), non-economic factor (corruption), sustainable growth definition, who coined 'Hindu rate of growth' (Raj Krishna).
- Sustainable development / Brundtland definition is the single most repeated item across APPSC papers (G1, 2023 lecturers, screening tests).
- Economist-theory attribution (Nurkse - vicious circle, Sen - capability) and index components (HDI excludes urbanisation; PQLI = IMR + literacy + LE at age one) are the standard traps.
- AP-specific items appear (AP Economic Development Board Act 2018); 'Limits to Growth' asked twice.

National income concepts - GDP, GNP, NDP, NNP, factor cost vs market price, GVA, deflator (11 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks definitional one-liners: NI = NNP at factor cost, per capita income = average income, real GDP = output at base-year prices, GNP deflator ratio.
- Recurring traps: MP vs FC differ by indirect taxes and subsidies (not direct taxes); GDP vs GNP differ by net factor income from abroad.
- A-R item on transfer earnings excluded from NI; GNP deflator rise lowers purchasing power; APSES SDP definition asked word for word.
- Other PSCs favour formula-statement items (NNP = GNP - depreciation, NI = NNP_MP - (IT - subsidies)) and 'best measure of growth = per capita real income'.

Geography (India, World & AP)

Disaster management framework - hazard vs disaster, DM Act 2005, NDMA, early warning systems (63 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single-fact years repeatedly: DM Act 2005, NPDM 2009, HPC Aug 1999, NDMA 2005/Sept 2006, first NDMP 2016, CWC flood forecasting 1958, APSDMA 2007.
- Heads of bodies are a staple: NDMA = Prime Minister, DDMA = DM/Collector ('any of them'), SDMA set up by Governor under s.14(1).
- Many APPSC items are conceptual one-liners on the DM cycle: risk assessment/vulnerability analysis = mitigation, non-structural mitigation = awareness, recovery not pre-disaster, IMD orange = be prepared.
- GIS/remote-sensing applications appear often as 'which is INCORRECT' with an absurd overclaim option (GIS directly locates victims, completely resolves social issues).

Andhra Pradesh - drainage: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Vamsadhara, Nagavali; reservoirs and canals (27 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks drainage as one-fact identification: 'X dam/project is on which river' (Srisailam, Somasila, Polavaram, Nagarjuna Sagar, Basava Sagar), 'river rises where' (Penna - Nandi hills), 'meets sea in which district' (Penna - Nellore), 'Gandikota on which river'.
- Recurring numbers: Godavari 1,465 km; 40 rivers / inter-state count; Tungabhadra forms 58 km AP-Karnataka boundary; Godavari 2 distributaries at Dowleswaram; Penna 536 km in AP. Wording decides the key ('longest' was keyed Godavari in 2025 and Penna in 2022).
- Project-purpose questions: Polavaram = National Project (Sec 90), Pattiseema = lift irrigation linking Godavari-Krishna (Limca record A-R), Telugu Ganga = Chennai/Tamil Nadu, KRMB allocates Srisailam water, NW-4 = Krishna waterway.

Andhra Pradesh - soil types and their distribution (26 APPSC questions)

- APPSC repeatedly asks one fact: red soil covers the largest area of AP (~66%) - asked in 8+ recruitment papers with near-identical wording.
- Other recurring AP items: deltaic alluvium = most fertile / most important for agriculture in K-G deltas; laterite ~1%, acidic, poor fertility; skeletal soils on eroded hill slopes; black soil = Regur/Vertisols.
- Trap statements: 'laterite formed in semi-arid low rainfall' (incorrect); very deep black soils in north-western Deccan.
- APPSC uses short A-R and 'which are correct' items about AP soil distribution (Nallamala skeletal soils, laterite for horticulture).

India - Peninsular drainage: east-flowing and west-flowing rivers, river basins, watershed (24 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: origin (Krishna-Mahabaleshwar), largest tributary (Pranhita / Tungabhadra), second largest basin (Godavari), which river is NOT west-flowing.
- AP tilt: Krishna's course (Mahabaleshwar-Sangli-Hamsaladeevi), Tungabhadra as Krishna tributary, Jayamangala-Pennar, NSTR on Krishna, Gokak falls-Ghataprabha.
- Other-PSC staples: west-flowing rivers have estuaries not deltas, rift-valley Narmada/Tapi, Amarkantak sources, waterfall-river pairs, lake-state pairs.
- Trap facts: Tapi lies between Satpura and Ajanta (not Vindhya); Pranhita = Wardha + Wainganga; Kosi is left-bank; Hagari = Vedavathi joins Tungabhadra.

India - rocks and mineral belts; distribution of metallic and non-metallic minerals (24 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single-fact place->mineral items (Kolar = gold, Bailadila haematite, Khetri/Malanjkhand copper, Kadapa asbestos, AP sole producer of apatite) and ore->metal items.
- Recurring AP angle: mica (Nellore), asbestos/barytes (Kadapa), Vizag iron ore exports to Japan, rare earths in Anantapur (NGRI 2023), mineral-production shares 2021-22 (Odisha 44.11%).
- APPSC also asks belt A/R (South-Western vs North-Eastern plateau), NW non-ferrous = copper, phlogopite/pegmatite = mica, placer = gold, first list of 30 critical minerals.

World - major rivers, lakes, seas, straits, canals and islands (23 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single-fact superlatives: longest river of Asia (Yangtze), deepest lake (Baikal), longest coastline (Canada), highest waterfall Angel Falls (3,212 ft), Dead Sea depth (1,385 ft).
- APPSC likes 'which is NOT' items (Victoria not a Great Lake) and river-mouth facts (Danube -> Black Sea, Mississippi -> Gulf of Mexico); its key uses Gulf of Mexico, not 'Atlantic'.
- Other PSC/UPSC staples: Mekong not through Malaysia, Caspian not bordering Armenia/Iraq, Black Sea not Croatia/Syria, Kiel = North Sea-Baltic, Michigan wholly in USA, Victoria Falls on Zambezi.
- Many filed PYQs are political geography / current affairs, not physical water bodies.

India - the Northern Plains, the Peninsular Plateau, the Coastal Plains and the Islands (21 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: which range has Kashmir/Kangra/Kullu valleys (Himachal), Shiwalik valleys = Duns, Lakshadweep capital Kavaratti, Barren = volcanic, Luni in Indian desert.
- Recurring facts: Sahyadri passes Bhorghat/Thalghat (vs Goran ghat trap), Satpura between Narmada-Tapi, Malwa in W MP + SE Rajasthan, Peninsular Plateau rich in metallic minerals, Ooty in Nilgiris.
- APPSC 2022 Group-IV style uses simple match-the-following and 'select all that apply' statement items with obvious distractors (Sahara in India).
- Other PSCs favour Ghats meeting point (Nilgiri), Anaimudi highest in South India, Dandakaranya states, Chota Nagpur minerals.

Earthquakes - causes, seismic waves, measurement, distribution, effects (19 APPSC questions)

- APPSC repeatedly asks seismic zone of a place: Delhi = Zone IV, Visakhapatnam = Zone II, AP = Zones II-III, Kutch/North-East = Zone V, least active = Zone II.
- Basic terms: epicentre has maximum intensity, seismology definition, seismograph as instrument, earthquakes cannot be predicted.
- Statement traps on focus vs epicentre ('epicentre directly below the focus' is wrong) and causes of tremors (meteor impacts).
- Occasional world facts: 1960 Chile M 9.5, Japan most earthquake-prone.

Hydrological disasters - floods, flash floods, cloudbursts, droughts, tsunamis, storm surges (19 APPSC questions)

- APPSC favours headline numbers from NDMA vulnerability profile: 58.6% landmass earthquake-prone, >40 mha flood-prone, ~5,700 km coast cyclone/tsunami-prone.
- Tsunami basics recur: Japanese origin, submarine earthquakes, slows near shore with height rising, 2004 origin Indian Ocean, worst-hit Tamil Nadu.
- Drought items use IMD deficiency thresholds (>50% = severe) and local Indian drought terms; flood items ask causes and expert-committee years (RBA, 2012 committee).
- AP angle: most cyclone-prone state, Rayalaseema drought, Budameru/Vijayawada floods, coastline rank after 2024 remeasurement.

Transport in Andhra Pradesh - highways, railway network, ports (Visakhapatnam, Krishnapatnam, Gangavaram, Kakinada), airports (18 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks port-location one-liners repeatedly (Krishnapatnam = Nellore asked 3+ times; Gangavaram = deep-water port; Bhogapuram near Vizag).
- Current-affairs statement items on AP projects are common: Errupalem-Nambur line (timeline trap), Vijayawada station green rating (IGBC vs LEED trap), airport losses, Kadapa-Renigunta highway.
- Count/rank facts: number of international airports (3), coastline rank (2nd on old 974 km; now 3rd), Vizag port traffic rank, NH-44 length.

Science, Technology & Environment

Relevance of science and technology to day-to-day life - health, food, transport, communication, household (56 APPSC questions)

- Overwhelmingly direct one-liners: vitamin -> deficiency/chemical name, gland -> hormone/location, household chemical -> formula (baking soda NaHCO3, Teflon = PTFE, milk of magnesia).
- APPSC-specific repeats: non-stick coating = Teflon/PTFE (3 times), sodium benzoate preservative, cola = phosphoric acid, PVC dialysis tubes, adrenal on kidney, kwashiorkor oedema.
- Common shapes elsewhere: 'not correctly matched' pairs, A/R on everyday physics (pressure cooker, altitude boiling point, myopia lens).
- Recent APPSC current-science items: Rhodamine B cotton-candy ban (2024), ultrasound for foetus A/R, 'decreased privacy not a positive impact'.

Goals of sustainable development - the 17 SDGs, targets and India's SDG Index performance (25 APPSC questions)

- APPSC repeatedly asks 'how many SDGs' (17), target year (2030), year adopted (2015) - at least ten near-identical items.
- Goal number -> title is the next most common shape (Goal 1 No Poverty, 2 Zero Hunger, 4 Quality Education, 6 Water & Sanitation, 8 Decent Work), plus 'which is NOT an SDG' (e.g. 'Life in sky').
- Match items pair SDGs with descriptions, socio-economic challenges or Indian schemes (Namami Gange = SDG 6, Ujjwala = clean energy, Ayushman Bharat = health, Samagra Shiksha = education).
- APPSC also asks SDG India Index (NITI Aayog) results: weakest goals (2 and 5 in 2020-21) and drivers of improvement (6 and 7).

Environmental hazards and disaster management - DM Act 2005, NDMA and NDRF, Sendai Framework, disaster types and mitigation (23 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct single-fact items: Sendai target year (2030), Target E (2020), Bhopal gas (MIC), Operation Vanilla (Madagascar), NIDM southern campus, nodal ministry (MHA).
- Statement items on DM Act 2005 NDMA powers (lays down policy, approves National Plan and ministry plans) and Yokohama 1994 / IDNDR dates recur.
- Conceptual DRR items: Disaster Crunch (Pressure-and-Release) model - vulnerability rooted in socio-economic processes; post-2015 frameworks trap (Hyogo NOT one).
- Classification questions ('which type of disaster is avalanche/biological flooding') and earthquake-resistant design (small, centrally located openings) appear.

Health and environment - vector-borne and water-borne diseases, air pollution and health, antimicrobial resistance, One Health (22 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks single-fact items: dengue lowers platelets, filariasis (lower-limb swelling), Fasciola invades liver, Gambusia for malaria control, ringworm = fungi, brucellosis = bacteria, air pollution hits respiratory system.
- Odd-one-out 'vector is not a mosquito' (leishmaniasis/kala-azar, sleeping sickness, plague) and 'not water-borne' (kwashiorkor, TB, hepatitis B, fluorosis) recur across PSCs.
- Pathogen-type classification (virus/bacteria/protozoa/fungus) and bird flu H5N1 vs swine flu H1N1 are frequent; other PSCs add Fleming-penicillin, Waksman, Widal/Mantoux tests.
- Recent APPSC Forest papers add livestock diseases (FMD, bovine TB, Chagas vector) and State of Global Air figures.

Environment - components; ecology, ecosystem, food chain and food web, energy flow, ecological pyramids (17 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: basic functional unit of ecology, first trophic level members (phytoplankton, vent bacteria, seaweeds), sequence of energy flow, secondary productivity definition, ecological pyramids as expression of trophic levels.
- Recurring APPSC keys: niche statements (both true), fundamental niche, carrying capacity definition, natality statements, standing crop/biomass, producers in terrestrial ecosystems.
- Traps: grazing chain starting with dead leaves, missing herbivore level, 'generating synthetic chemicals' as an environment function, inverted pyramids (pond biomass, parasitic/tree numbers), energy pyramid never inverted.
- Other-PSC PYQs add biomagnification (top predator), lichen/mycorrhiza partners, halophyte/xerophyte/hydrophyte terms, insectivorous plants and nitrogen-poor soil.

Solid waste, plastic waste, e-waste, biomedical and construction waste - rules and management (14 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks direct one-liners: biodegradable vs non-biodegradable item (tin, wool, peels), zero-waste city (Indore), 3R odd-one-out ('Regain'), urban disposal methods ('all the above').
- Rule-year-goal items recur: MSW Rules 2000 = segregation; PWM Amendment 2021 = SUP phase-out by 2022; EPR origin = E-waste Rules 2011 (UPSC).
- Strong AP/current-affairs tilt: CLAP launch date (2 Oct 2021) incl. assertion-reason, APPCB RDF in cement kilns, Water Plus cities, Swachh Survekshan themes.
- Disposal-method matching (organic-composting, e-waste-recycling, hazardous-incineration, glass-landfill) and WtE terms (pyrolysis, plasma gasification) are favourite match items.

International environmental treaties - Stockholm 1972, Rio 1992, Ramsar, CITES, CBD and its protocols (13 APPSC questions)

- APPSC asks one-line identifications: Ramsar = wetlands, CITES = endangered species trade (Washington Convention), Nagoya = part of CBD, IUCN full form, International Year of Biodiversity 2010.
- Recent APPSC items probe definitions (Nagoya 'utilization of genetic resources' = R&D on genetic/biochemical composition) and CA conferences (CMS COP14 Samarkand 2024).
- Other PSCs test GEF facts, Montreux Record meaning, Cartagena = biosafety (MoEF nodal), UN Decade on Biodiversity 2011-20.

S&T institutions - ICAR, ICMR, ICFRE, DRDO, ISRO, DAE, DoS and their mandates (11 APPSC questions)

- Overwhelmingly 'institute - location' single-fact items (CTRI Rajahmundry, NRCWA Bhubaneswar, NATMO Kolkata, NIO Goa, IIFM Bhopal, FRI Dehradun, NIV Pune).
- APPSC tilts to AP-located institutes and recent S&T news items (LIGO-India lead labs, ICAR lumpy skin vaccine, IIT research items).
- Mismatch-pair format ('not correctly matched') is common in other PSCs; APPSC mostly direct one-liners.

Earth observation - IRS series, Cartosat, Resourcesat, Oceansat, RISAT, EOS series and applications (11 APPSC questions)

- APPSC tests remote-sensing basics: active sensor = laser, infrared sensors for volcanic heat, non-components/non-resolutions as traps ('minimisation', 'chemical').
- Direct identification: first mapping satellite = Cartosat-1, geo-imaging = EOS-03, NISAR = NASA-ISRO, INFFRAS, MODIS full form.
- Navigation-system owner match (Galileo = EU, GLONASS = Russia) recurs as 'incorrect pair'.

Applications of space technology - agriculture, disaster management, telemedicine, tele-education, navigation (11 APPSC questions)

- APPSC's favourite shape: 'which CANNOT be monitored / is NOT an application' - answer is the human-health event, chemical soil testing, earthquake prediction or news channels.
- Direct recall of names/full forms: MOSDAC full form, Meghdoot (IMD+ICAR), QGIS as open-source GIS, digitizer as GIS hardware, Nabhmitra.
- GIS basics (store/manipulate/analyse/display) and NRSC flood-prone basin (Ganga-Brahmaputra) appear repeatedly.